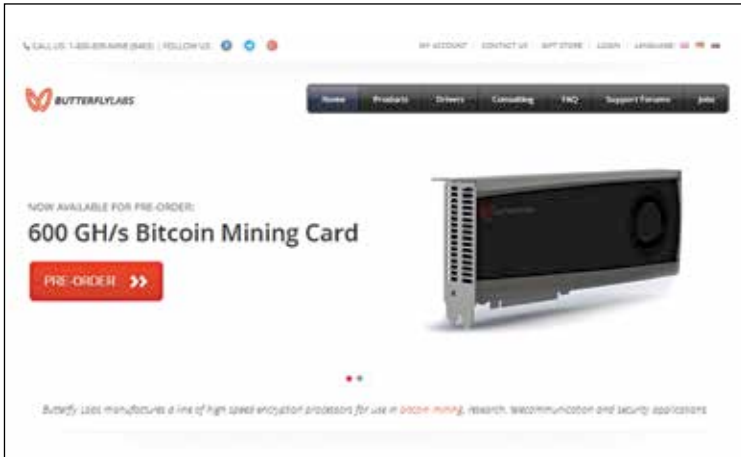




Major hardware providers have been accused of not delivering on time or up to standards, taking advantage of the mining boom.

Many fraudulent websites offer hardware for Bitcoin mining claiming themselves to be the next generation of technology. In many cases this may be true but it is also one of the common ways of trying to defraud naive users. In many cases, these websites take advance payments for yet to be released rigs and then delay delivery or default completely without returning their customers money. Its important to seek reviews of any website or equipment source before making any payments for future deliveries. Even long time active providers such as ButterFlyLabs (that sponsored the Bitcoin Conference) have been accused by the Bitcoin community of irregular behaviour such as delayed delivery and product thats not as claimed. Do your research.

Another risk to miners or even regular users is from malware and trojans that can slave your computers processor to work in the mining pool without any indication. Over 12,000 personal computers have already been infected by Bitcoin malware that makes them into virtual assets for criminals. Not only does this result in a severe slowdown of the infected system but also leaves the system vulnerable to other attacks.

Ponzi Scam

Bitcoin has itself been called a Ponzi scam since it's inception but due to its decentralised nature it has proven to be nothing of the kind. However, the traditional Ponzi scam can still be used on the Bitcoin system without